



**Jay Pullur**  
Founder and CEO  
Pramati Technologies

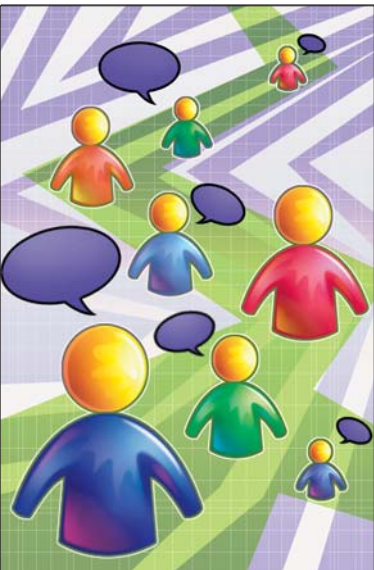
**B**logging and business social networking are crucial parts of business today, particularly in the hi-tech industry. It would be wise for companies to use the movement to their benefit. We want our employees to be smarter, well-read, articulate, and well-connected. Web 2.0 helps this cause.

There would certainly be part of employees' time going into non-productive purposes. However, when companies encourage blogging and tell them what areas would help business and the branding cause, at least a reasonable part of the time spent could be productive.

Social networking including professional networking can open up the minds of employees. Traditional channels like conferences and seminars provided opportunities for people to connect with related people. Online communities, technology forums, and special-interest groups all form various social networking opportunities. The value of such social networking is manifold—the most important for us is branding.

Small and medium companies should see blogging and social networking as an equaliser, because on the Web, no-one knows the size of your office. Bigger companies can also benefit, but they probably have the need for regulatory mechanisms.

# BUSINESSES



**Bhavin Turakhia**  
CEO  
Directi

**A**t Directi, blogging has enhanced the communication give and take among various audience verticals. Employee blogging manages to reach out to a larger credible audience, and allows employees to express themselves in the most creative of ways.

A blog by a company employee gives an inside view of the company and would hence positively affect the company's brand image. At Directi, we have employees who write blogs for creative expression, and others who try to address technical and soft issues they face in their work domain. This transforms a nameless and faceless organisation into one with a personal and very live face.

Negative comments about companies on blogs should be accepted in the right spirit and an attempt must be made to mutually understand issues and correct them.

Social / Business networking, too, most definitely works for us. It helps in popularising products and services to the right target audience. Moreover, social networking gives a much-needed personal side to business deals and also opens up thousands of prospective sales leads. Companies must encourage employee social networking.



**Rajul Garg**  
Vice president  
Corporate and People  
Development,  
GlobalLogic

**W**e as a company are firm believers in the individual's power of expression. It's liberating to be able to speak your mind and have others comment on it. Personal trust and responsibility are integral parts of our culture and blogging has helped us spread that.

The policy of allowing blogging by employees has re-enforced our culture of personal trust and responsibility. Hence, at a macro level, it has helped.

We do not have a formal monitoring mechanism for employee blogs. We may have the need in the future as it gets bigger in scale.

Regarding access to social networking sites for professional purposes, we are working on creating a business community partnering with a popular social networking provider. We think this will act as a social glue and help people relate to each other more as people.

We are big believers in the power of collaboration and how the new, new Web makes it possible. It ties in very well to breed innovation, which is our fundamental need.

*As told to Prakash Ballakoor (prakash\_ballakoor@thinkdigit.com)*